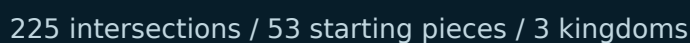


Illustrated rules, 21 named pieces and the complete timed tutorial



Which rules are we playing?

This edition follows the Chinese **Free Play Method** tutorial supplied for this project. The speaker explicitly mixes official rules with private additions. The organized rules below keep that distinction; the complete 588-cue English transcript appears after the manual, so introductions, explanations, historical asides, examples and closing remarks remain available.

Label	Meaning at this table
Tutorial rule	A rule demonstrated or described in the supplied video. This is the default playable edition.
Agreed Free Play addition	A private or expanded convention described by the speaker, such as inherited Advisor palace transfers and restrictions protecting an ally.
Proposed option	Early-conquest Han balancing, suggested to the designers. It is NOT presented as an adopted official rule and defaults to off.
Written supplement	Differences and extra modes documented by the linked 2020 written article. They are recorded separately rather than silently changing the tutorial.
Digital convention	A necessary, disclosed adjudication for a situation the video does not settle. Examples: one Advisor per transfer move, explicit repeated-check counting, and stalemate passing.

Quick start

1. Place the three 16-piece armies and five Han pieces as in the opening diagram.
2. Choose six or nine repeated checks for the previous-seat limit; leave the proposed Han balance option off unless everyone agrees.
3. Wu / Green opens. Continue Wu, Wei, Shu, except that a single checked faction answers immediately.
4. Move one controlled piece per turn. Use Horses to force alliances or seize Han. Keep your own and allied kings safe.
5. Remove a mated king immediately and transfer its surviving army to the direct victor. Continue until one kingdom remains or the survivors draw.

The existing Arctic three-arm Sanguo Qi and San You Qi engines provide useful design patterns, but their Y-board junctions, blocked leaps, flying-General rules and extra Fire/Flag/Bannerman pieces are not imported into this cross-board ruleset. Standard Xiangqi supplies the seven-role vocabulary and line-capture model.

The board and opening armies

Pieces occupy **intersections**, not squares. The lattice has 17 files and 17 ranks. Remove the four 4-by-4 corner blocks: $289 - 64 = 225$ **playable points**. The outside ornamental border is not a movement line. The central 8-by-8 square region is the common battlefield; each arm is a half-Xiangqi home sector.

Force	Arctic identity / position	Starting force
Wei	Pengu Order / Blue / top	16 pieces
Shu	Retsba Legion / Red / bottom	16 pieces
Wu	Abster Tribe / Green / right	16 pieces
Han	Gold neutral reserve / left	Emperor 1; Chariots 3; Cannon 1

Arrange each player army

Along the outer back rank, from one side to the other: **Chariot, Horse, Elephant, Advisor, King, Advisor, Elephant, Horse, Chariot**. The King is on file 9; the Chariots are on files 5 and 13. The two Cannons stand two ranks in front of the back rank, under the Horse files. Five Soldiers stand three ranks in front of the back rank, on alternating points.

The Soldier starting rank is the **defensive line**. The next line toward the center is the **national boundary**. Wu faces the initially inactive Han reserve, while Wei and Shu face each other. This asymmetry explains Wu moving first and the opening Cannon limitation.

Han setup and inactive status

The Emperor starts at Luoyang, on the middle point of the left outer edge. The three Han Chariots stand on the Hulao Pass line, at two-point spacing above and below its center. The Han Cannon is one point behind the middle Chariot. In global diagram coordinates, Emperor (0,8); Chariots (3,6), (3,8), (3,10); Cannon (2,8). Global coordinates count left-to-right and top-to-bottom from 0 to 16.

Before activation, Han pieces cannot move or be captured. The sole exception is a Horse capturing the Emperor to trigger regicide. Inactive Han pieces still block line movement and may serve as Cannon screens. There are **48 player pieces plus 5 Han pieces**; the 21 illustrations are seven role designs times three player colors, not the number of pieces on the board.

Diagram key: K King; A Advisor; E Elephant; H Horse; R Chariot; C Cannon; P Soldier; Hn Han Emperor.

03 / FIELD MANUAL

The 21 individually named pieces

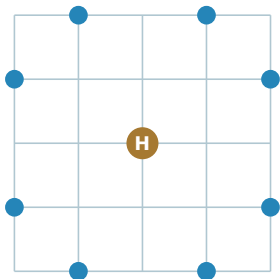
Each illustration is a separate transparent 512-by-512 WebP file. The physical role, move and starting quantity are identical across the three factions; faction color identifies its original army. A controller ring identifies a later inherited piece. The Han reserve uses dedicated gold markers on the board.

Role / copies	Blue / Pengu Order	Green / Abster Tribe	Red / Retsba Legion
Frost King King x 1	 blue-king.webp	 green-king.webp	 red-king.webp
Shield Guard Advisor x 2	 blue-advisor.webp	 green-advisor.webp	 red-advisor.webp
Royal Mammoth Elephant x 2	 blue-elephant.webp	 green-elephant.webp	 red-elephant.webp
Ice Unicorn Horse x 2	 blue-horse.webp	 green-horse.webp	 red-horse.webp
War Chariot Chariot x 2	 blue-chariot.webp	 green-chariot.webp	 red-chariot.webp
Frost Cannon Cannon x 2	 blue-cannon.webp	 green-cannon.webp	 red-cannon.webp
Penguin Spearman Soldier x 5	 blue-soldier.webp	 green-soldier.webp	 red-soldier.webp

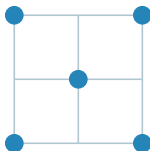
The names above retain the historical role in the inspector and movement manual: the Unicorn is a Horse, the Mammoth an Elephant, the Shield Guard an Advisor, and the Penguin Spearman a Soldier. Artwork changes do not add abilities.

How the seven roles move

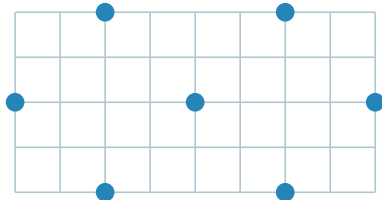
Piece	Legal movement / capture
King	One orthogonal point within its own nine-point palace. Wei and Shu may face directly in this video edition. A mated King loses its kingdom.
Advisor	One diagonal point along the five connected palace points. Inherited Advisors have a separate palace-transfer move; see inheritance.
Elephant	Two points diagonally, among its seven home points. No blocked-eye restriction. It cannot capture another home Elephant across a national boundary it is not allowed to cross.
Horse	Two points along one axis and one along the other. No blocked-leg restriction. Its straight and diagonal components must remain on the cross. Only Horses trigger alliances or regicide.
Chariot	Any number of points on a clear horizontal or vertical line. It captures the first enemy on its destination. It cannot jump over any piece.
Cannon	Move like a Chariot without capture. A capture must pass exactly one occupied point, of any side. It cannot capture with zero or two screens. Opening restriction: see next page.
Soldier	One orthogonal point. At home: forward or sideways. Beyond its own national boundary: all four directions, but retreat only as far as its own boundary.



Horse



Advisor



Elephant

Blue dots mark geometric destinations or the complete palace/home-point network, before occupants and king safety are considered. An occupied Horse leg or Elephant eye does not block its jump; a missing board corner still blocks the route.

Move exactly one piece per turn. Friendly and allied occupied destinations are unavailable. Captures remove the opposing piece and place the moving piece on its point. Active Kings are resolved by checkmate, not clicked and captured as ordinary tokens.

Boundaries, corners and opening fire

Soldiers: the national boundary is decisive

A Soldier may move sideways from its first move. It may advance from its defensive line to its national boundary, but cannot retreat from that boundary to the defensive line. Once it advances beyond the boundary, it may move forward, sideways or backward, even in another kingdom or Han territory. Its backward return stops at its own national boundary. It never changes into a forward-only enemy Soldier just because it enters enemy territory.

For example, Blue advances toward increasing global y. On y=3 it may step to y=4 or sideways, never y=2. On y=4 it may advance to y=5 or move sideways, never y=3. On y=5 it may return to y=4. An inherited Soldier uses the receiving controller's forward direction and boundary.

Cannons: the first full round

The video forbids a Cannon moving beyond the starting Soldier defensive line during the very first round. From its starting rank it can move sideways, or one point forward or backward. This restriction applies to the opening round of the game, **not to the first move of every individual Cannon**. It disappears in the middle game.

The speaker explains that unrestricted opening Cannons would let Wei and Shu endanger a Wu Chariot before Wu can set up its defence. Wu can use its first turn to shift a Cannon, develop a Horse, or slide a Soldier. A connected Soldier line gives strong defensive support.

The missing corners are real restrictions

No piece may occupy the outer ornamental border or any of the four blank corner regions. Chariot and Cannon rays stop where the playable cross ends. Soldiers cannot step into the blank area. A Horse requires a valid straight first point and a diagonal continuation that stays on the cross; a valid endpoint alone is insufficient. An Elephant's diagonal route must also stay inside the cross.

This is a route restriction, not the ordinary Xiangqi blocked-leg/blocked-eye rule. Occupied intermediate points do not stop Horse or Elephant jumps. The board artwork and pixel spacing never decide legality; the engine uses exact integer cross-board coordinates.

Inactive Han as terrain

Before activation, the Emperor, three Chariots and Cannon are immobile obstacles. Any of them may be the single screen for an otherwise valid Cannon capture. A Chariot facing the same blocked line cannot capture through the Han piece. The inactive Han military units themselves cannot be captured.

Turn order, check and repeated checks

Normal sequence

Wu / Green → Wei / Blue → Shu / Red → Wu, skipping defeated factions. On an ordinary turn, make one legal move with one piece under your control. You must not leave your own King in check.

A single checked faction answers immediately

If Wei checks Wu, Wu responds immediately, even though Shu would normally follow Wei. After Wu answers, play continues with Wu's next player: Wei. Wei therefore gets another move. The speaker encourages attacking the previous player because this can change the tempo. If two or more factions are checked simultaneously, keep the normal seat order. Remove a checkmated King as soon as the mate is established.

Allied king safety in this Free Play edition

Allied pieces do not give check to one another. A King may safely stand behind or within the attack pattern of an allied piece. However, in the video's protective convention, an ally must not move a shielding piece so as to expose the allied King to an enemy attack. A pinned allied Chariot may keep moving along the shielding file but may not slide away from it.

Perpetual check against the previous seat

Agree on six or nine rounds before play. Repeating an unchanged checking cycle against your previous seat interrupts the third player's opportunities; the speaker treats this as prohibited once the agreed threshold is reached. If the checker refuses to change, it loses and its surviving army passes to the checked previous player. Perpetual check against the next seat is allowed because normal turn order is preserved.

Digital counting convention: this table counts repeated checking positions in a continuous cycle against the previous seat. A new position or capture resets the count. It warns on the selected sixth or ninth repeated check; another unchanged repetition forfeits. A progressing series of distinct checks is not penalized, and a completed mate takes priority over the repetition penalty. This precise counter is implementation detail supplied for consistency where the narration only gives a six-or-nine-round choice.

Alliance, regicide and the Han reserve

Horse action	Alliance	Han controller
Lands on its own faction's point	No change	No change
Lands on another faction's point while all three survive	Mover + marked faction	The third faction
Captures the inactive Emperor	The other two survivors unite, if both remain	The Horse's controller
Later visits an alliance / regicide point after activation	No new effect	Existing controller keeps Han

How a Horse forces an alliance

Beside the Emperor: the **upper point is Shu**, the **right point is Wu**, the **lower point is Wei**. A Horse landing on another faction's marked point creates the alliance instantly. It does not require consent, and an accidental landing counts. Your own marked point is an ordinary destination with no effect. The allies cannot capture or check one another; they attack the third kingdom, which gains the three Han Chariots and Cannon.

How a Horse seizes Han

Only a Horse can capture the inactive Emperor. Its controller gains the three Han Chariots and Cannon. If two other kingdoms survive, they ally automatically against the regicide faction. The tutorial moves the Han token to the receiving ruler's position as a marker: it still represents that faction's original King, with the same identity, palace and defeat condition. This table follows that marker convention and vacates the Emperor's old point on activation.

When an alliance ends

No player may cancel it voluntarily or replace it by visiting a different point. It dissolves automatically when one ally is defeated or the common opponent is defeated. The remaining kingdoms become enemies. Han units remain with their controller and transfer with its army if that controller is checkmated. Activation is a one-time event. If only two kingdoms remain before any activation, alliance points have no effect, but Horse regicide can still claim Han.

The proposed balance option

The speaker suggests that if a kingdom checkmates another before alliance or regicide, Han should automatically reinforce the third kingdom. Example: Wei defeats Wu, so Shu receives Han to offset Wei's inherited army. The designers only said they would consider the idea. It is a **proposal**, not an adopted rule. The game offers it as an explicitly labeled, off-by-default house option.

Defeat, inheritance and defence

Checkmate and army ownership

When a King has no legal response to check, that faction loses immediately. Remove the King. Every surviving piece controlled by the defeated faction passes to the victor, including Advisors, Elephants and already-activated Han pieces. The original artwork stays; a controller ring and ownership tag show the new allegiance. A conquered army that later loses transfers onward to the final victor.

When two attackers combine, credit the faction that can directly deliver the mate with its own controlled forces. If the moving faction also directly checks the mated King, prefer it. If its move merely opens another faction's attack or supplies that faction's Cannon screen, the direct checking faction inherits. A tactical contribution alone does not claim the army. This is the borrowed-knife distinction.

Inherited Advisors: palace transfer

An inherited Advisor may be moved directly to an **empty, normally reachable Advisor point** in the receiving King's palace. It does not walk across the battlefield. The transfer consumes an entire move: no transfer followed by a second piece move. This table transfers one Advisor per turn. The receiving kingdom need not first lose one of its own Advisors, so inherited Advisors can reinforce an already occupied palace as long as a legal point is free.

Inherited Elephants: neighboring home networks

Elephants may cross a conquered neighboring boundary to help defend the controller's homeland, one normal two-point diagonal jump at a time. The connected pair can be Wei-Wu or Shu-Wu. They still use the seven-point Elephant networks of controlled regions and still cannot cut a missing corner. Alliance alone does not transfer territorial control.

Wei and Shu are opposite, so an inherited Elephant cannot cross enemy Wu to get between them. If the controller also owns Han, a route through Han can connect their home-point networks. The speaker notes that this is a long and dangerous journey: the Elephant could be captured en route, and in practice the rule is rarely useful.

Do not confuse this Free Play defence expansion with ordinary Xiangqi, or with the later written edition's stricter stay-in-the-original-camp Advisors and Elephants. The comparison appendix records those differences.

Resignation, wins and draws

Resignation leaves an inactive army

A player may resign mid-game. Turn its King face down. Its pieces **stay exactly where they stand**, no longer move, and are not inherited by either opponent. They remain line blockers and Cannon screens. The other players **may capture them**: they do not become invulnerable stones. The remaining kingdoms may continue fighting or competing for still-inactive Han.

A resigned kingdom is defeated and its seat is skipped. If it controlled Han, those Han units become inactive with the rest of its army; they do not reactivate under a new player. An existing alliance ends when a participating kingdom resigns.

Victory belongs to the final survivor

A kingdom that eliminates both others wins. It may defeat them directly or inherit the forces of a kingdom that had already defeated one rival. Example: Wu defeats Wei, then Shu defeats Wu; Shu is the final winner. A former victor does not retain victory after its own King is mated.

A draw among the survivors

If no surviving faction can checkmate another, the survivors draw. If Wu has already defeated Wei and then Wu and Shu cannot mate one another, Wu and Shu draw; Wei has lost. The game asks every surviving human player to approve a local draw. Bots accept that local agreement. It automatically draws when only non-mating home-defence roles remain, or all remaining seats lack legal moves.

Stalemate is a disclosed completion rule

The supplied tutorial does not decide an unchecked seat with no legal move. The original 2007 patent permits that seat to pass. This Free Play implementation uses that pass convention and continues to the next surviving seat. It does not invent a victor from the last move. The later written article instead treats stalemate as a loss with cause-based inheritance; that separate rule is recorded in the supplement.

There is no imported automatic threefold-repetition or 120-quiet-move draw in this edition. The previous-seat perpetual-check rule and agreed-draw controls are the relevant mechanisms.

Recording moves and historical time

Controller-relative files

Number files **1 through 17 from each player's right to left**. The central King file is 9; starting Chariots occupy files 5 and 13. From Wu's view, files 1-4 extend toward Wei, and 14-17 toward Shu. Han has no separate notation. A Han unit uses the file numbers of whoever currently controls it.

Controller	Global point (x,y) becomes
Wei / Blue	File = 17 - x; depth = y + 1
Shu / Red	File = x + 1; depth = 17 - y
Wu / Green	File = 17 - y; depth = 17 - x

The game journal records both start and destination, the controller, role, capture and political result. This is an unambiguous digital coordinate supplement to the traditional advance/retreat/sideways notation.

Identical pieces sharing a file

Use **front / rear** for two; **front / middle / rear** for three. With more pieces on a single file, number them from the front: first, second, third, and so on. Lower numbers are farther forward from their controller's perspective. This applies to inherited armies and Han units too.

Examples retained from the tutorial: two Cannons on Wei file 10 require "Rear Cannon, sideways to file 7." A middle Cannon can similarly move sideways to file 7. Five Chariots on one file can be distinguished as "Fourth Chariot, sideways to file 9," which is not "Chariot on file 4 to file 9." In the hypothetical seven-Chariot case, "Sixth Chariot, sideways to file 7" identifies the sixth piece in the line.

Historical round labels are storytelling

The narrator rejects one round per month: a 117-round game would finish the conflict in under ten years. One season per round gives four rounds per year; around 120 rounds gives thirty years, still short beside the AD 184-280 narrative span of 96 years. He therefore favors **one complete round as one year**, starting with the Yellow Turban Rebellion in AD 184. He contrasts this with the official AD 189 starting convention, tied to Dong Zhuo's upheaval. These are historical labels, not gameplay timers.

The tutorial's extra information

Cities, editions and the historical setting

Faction	Capital / locations named by the narrator
Wei	Xuchang; Xuzhou, Runan, Xinye, Wancheng, Chang'an
Wu	Jianye; Shouchun, Lujiang, Chaisang, Xiangyang, Jiangling
Shu	Chengdu; Yong'an, Shangyong, Hanzhong, Jiange; one remaining city name is not identified in the narration
Han	Luoyang; Hulao Pass

The speaker describes Wei before formal usurpation of Han, Shu after gaining Western Sichuan, and Liu Bei's deathbed entrustment at Yong'an. He candidly says he enjoys the game more than he knows every historical story. His board is sixth edition; fifth and sixth use the same layout. First and second editions also named the Cannon locations, but those two labels were removed from the third edition onward.

Tactics explained, without overstating the examples

Borrowed knife (32:29-32:51). Another player's next move may capture the piece you have induced an opponent to expose. The narrator demonstrates a Wei Horse that Shu can capture on its turn. Two-birds and three-birds combinations are mentioned but not worked through.

Chariot versus Horse near the Emperor (33:05-34:18). In some approach positions one Chariot covers both of a Horse's regicide routes. Remember the four-small-squares pattern formed by their positions. Other approaches give two separated entry routes, requiring two Chariots. The spoken “here” references depend on the video's exact setup; no unseen coordinate is fabricated in this rulebook.

Han forks after alliance (34:24-36:18). A Horse near Han can force both opponents to react, even at the price of sacrificing a Chariot to stop regicide. After an alliance activates Han, the alliance-making Horse can fork newly active Chariots, trade for a Chariot, or capture a Cannon and continue the fork. The narrator recommends moving the relevant Han Chariot well away. In his specific Shu-Wu example, two four-square patterns contain the Horse; this is not a blanket guarantee for every Shu-Wu alliance.

The introduction credits another enthusiastic creator whose name could not be verified. The closing explains that earlier recordings were deleted and this tutorial was remade at that creator's urging. Those remarks, the brief unclear phrase near 21:49, and the unclear fork description near 35:34 are retained as marked transcript cues rather than silently omitted.

12 / FIELD MANUAL

Written supplements and source notes

The linked 2020 article was edited in 2021. Its extra rules are separate from the video edition. This concise comparison preserves the additional procedural facts without reproducing the article's prose. [B]

Written-edition difference [B]	Tutorial game setting
Facing Wei-Shu Kings forbidden.	Allowed.
Opening Cannon may reach national boundary.	Defensive-line limit.
Ally may expose allied King.	Allied King protected.
Inherited Advisors/Elephants stay in original camps.	Defence transfers allowed.
After alliance, Emperor remains immobile and invulnerable.	Royal-marker convention vacates Luoyang.
Resignation removes army; stalemate loses with cause-based inheritance.	Inactive capturable army; stalemate passes.

Other written options [B]: rapid finish compares material after the first defeat: Chariot 5, Horse/Cannon 3, Soldier/Advisor/Elephant 1, King uncounted. Fourth-edition character duels need named-character stickers, a die and three cards; their complete procedure is not supplied here. Match points: first defeated 1, second defeated 0, winner 2; surviving drawers 1 each; three-way draw 1 each. A three-player resignation scores -1; resignation with two remaining has no deduction. An optional, historically unstable extension promotes a Soldier at the center to Horse if its faction has no Horses; once per faction. None of these extras is enabled in this tutorial game.

Sources and authority

[A] User-supplied audio: **Sanguo Yan Yi Qi “Free Play Method” introductory tutorial**, duration 36:51.814. The preserved English SRT contains 588 cues, ending at 36:48.760; the remaining tail is not assigned invented speech. Source times cited in the manual refer to that audio.

[B] User-linked Bilibili article: [bilibili.com/opus/380944400655958160](https://www.bilibili.com/opus/380944400655958160) (also cv5726320), introductory rules with later written clarifications. Differences are recorded above.

[C] Original board-and-rules patent CN2870925Y, published 2007: patents.google.com/patent/CN2870925Y/zh. Confirms the cross-board, 53 pieces and neutral reserve; earlier details such as the opening seat or Emperor treatment must not override the supplied tutorial.

[D] World Xiangqi Federation: [A Short Introduction to Xiangqi](#). Used for vocabulary and ordinary role mechanics, with this variant's explicit exceptions. Arctic's existing Xiangqi, historical Sanguo Qi and San You Qi source engines were reviewed for presentation, role naming and validation patterns.

Using the game and English subtitles

Open the campaign

arcticdominion.xyz/?game=heritage-arcade&table=sanguo opens this edition. The main Heritage Arcade features it too. Choose three humans on one device, two humans plus a bot, or one human plus two bots. Choose your faction and Casual or Tactical bots when applicable.

Select any piece to inspect it. On your turn, select one controlled piece and click a glowing intersection to move. Orange rings identify captures. Role labels can be toggled. Zoom, fit and fullscreen help on smaller displays. The seat list shows who controls each army and how many active pieces remain. The campaign journal records moves, Han activation, alliances and inherited armies.

Local matches save automatically on this device. Resume from setup. Undo returns to the saved position before your latest human action; in a bot game it also rolls back the intervening bot replies. Resign and agreed draw have explicit confirmation controls. Download the journal as JSON for reviewing a completed match. The original Y-board table and online rooms remain accessible through the separate legacy link.

Load the timed English SRT

Use **Sanguo-Yan-Yi-Qi-Free-Play-English.srt** with the exact 36:52 tutorial audio/video version. In VLC or another local player, add it through the subtitle-file menu. For automatic loading, put it next to the video and give both files the same base filename. Start subtitle synchronization at **0.000 seconds**; the cue times are measured from the beginning of the supplied audio, including its initial silence.

The SRT is UTF-8, with sequential cue numbers, valid SubRip timestamps, no overlapping cues and no Chinese text. The complete transcript below uses the same cue IDs, wording and start/end times. Proper names or brief phrases that could not be verified are explicitly marked unclear. The file preserves those gaps rather than guessing the creator's name or a tactical statement.

Tutorial time map

Time	Content
00:03-03:19	Introduction, board, Han reserve, cities and board editions
03:22-09:34	Moves, Soldier boundaries, Cannon opening and neutral screens
09:40-15:39	Turn priority, alliance, regicide and proposed Han balance
15:46-22:20	Inheritance, wins/draws, ally protection and perpetual check
22:40-26:16	Missing-corner routes and resignation
26:28-32:15	Coordinates, identical-piece notation and historical years
32:21-36:48	Tactical examples, Han defence and closing remarks

APPENDIX / ALL 588 CUES

Complete English timed transcript

Same wording and timing as the SRT. Cue ranges are hours:minutes:seconds,milliseconds. The transcript is preserved in spoken order, including examples, corrections, historical asides and marked uncertainties.

001 00:00:03,430 - 00:00:04,770

Hello, everyone on Bilibili.

002 00:00:05,110 - 00:00:10,860

At the strong urging of another Bilibili creator [name unclear],

003 00:00:10,860 - 00:00:16,570

I'll demonstrate the game in this tutorial.

004 00:00:17,750 - 00:00:23,270

This mainly covers some official Sanguo Yan Yi Qi rules,

005 00:00:23,270 - 00:00:28,910

as well as some rules we devised privately that most of us accept.

006 00:00:29,360 - 00:00:34,050

First, let me briefly explain what Sanguo Yan Yi Qi is.

007 00:00:34,790 - 00:00:39,780

It combines Romance of the Three Kingdoms with Chinese chess,

008 00:00:39,860 - 00:00:43,460

two well-known cultural elements, in a tabletop game.

009 00:00:44,540 - 00:00:47,064

Look at the video to see how the pieces are arranged.

010 00:00:48,610 - 00:00:51,350

How is the board designed?

011 00:00:51,550 - 00:00:54,650

Wei and Shu face each other directly.

012 00:00:54,710 - 00:00:59,350

But Wu has no active opposing force directly across from it.

013 00:00:59,410 - 00:01:00,770

Which force is opposite Wu?

014 00:01:00,910 - 00:01:04,010

The Eastern Han. During play,

015 00:01:04,320 - 00:01:09,930

Han cannot move unless the emperor is killed or an alliance is formed.

016 00:01:09,930 - 00:01:15,740

So initially, Wu has no force directly confronting it. Now look at

017 00:01:15,740 - 00:01:21,390

the board's layout. Wei occupies Xuchang.

018 00:01:21,860 - 00:01:27,490

Cao Wei had not yet usurped the Han throne, so its capital is still Xuchang.

019 00:01:27,490 - 00:01:33,520

Wu's capital is Jianye. There is little to add there. Then look at

020 00:01:33,520 - 00:01:35,300

Shu, whose capital is Chengdu.

021 00:01:36,550 - 00:01:39,410

It has already taken Western Sichuan.

022 00:01:39,490 - 00:01:41,830

Liu Bei has already conquered that region.

023 00:01:41,930 - 00:01:46,070

The emperor's position here, Emperor Xian of Han, represents Luoyang.

024 00:01:46,460 - 00:01:50,490

Outside Luoyang is Hulao Pass.

025 00:01:50,570 - 00:01:53,840

Look, this is Hulao Pass.

026 00:01:56,080 - 00:01:58,480

Emperor Xian has three chariots and one cannon.

027 00:01:58,640 - 00:02:01,220

They are stationed here at Luoyang and Hulao Pass.

028 00:02:02,160 - 00:02:08,620

Besides its capital, each faction has five important strongholds.

029 00:02:09,130 - 00:02:12,710

Here in Wei are Xuzhou and Runan,

030 00:02:13,450 - 00:02:15,770

Xinye and Wancheng,

031 00:02:16,350 - 00:02:20,090

and Chang'an. In the first and second editions of the board,

032 00:02:20,150 - 00:02:25,150

the two cannon positions also had city names. From the third edition onward,

033 00:02:25,830 - 00:02:27,910

those two city names were omitted.

034 00:02:29,170 - 00:02:31,090

I'm using the sixth-edition board.

035 00:02:31,150 - 00:02:34,710

The fifth and sixth editions both use this same board design.

036 00:02:34,770 - 00:02:36,920

Now look at Wu.

037 00:02:36,980 - 00:02:38,520

Here is Shouchun,

038 00:02:39,980 - 00:02:42,130

Lujiang and Chaisang,

039 00:02:43,700 - 00:02:45,730

Xiangyang and Jiangling.

040 00:02:46,530 - 00:02:49,430

I don't know exactly what happened in these cities.

041 00:02:49,530 - 00:02:53,750

I simply enjoy playing Sanguo Yan Yi Qi.

042 00:02:53,750 - 00:02:57,179

I'm not very familiar with the stories in Romance of the Three Kingdoms.

043 00:02:57,750 - 00:03:02,170

So I can only give you a brief introduction based on the board's layout.

044 00:03:02,230 - 00:03:03,870

Here in Shu is Yong'an.

045 00:03:04,150 - 00:03:07,648

I know about Liu Bei's deathbed entrustment at Yong'an,

046 00:03:07,648 - 00:03:09,810

so I'm not a totally ignorant fan!

047 00:03:10,480 - 00:03:13,110

Then there are Shangyong and Hanzhong.

048 00:03:14,370 - 00:03:17,230

And Jiange. That is quite a famous place.

049 00:03:17,410 - 00:03:19,610

I don't know the name of the place below it.

050 00:03:20,200 - 00:03:21,920

Now, on to the main topic.

051 00:03:22,950 - 00:03:25,890

First I'll explain how the pieces move.

052 00:03:26,390 - 00:03:29,630

Their moves are basically the same as in Chinese chess,

053 00:03:29,690 - 00:03:31,830

but there are some differences.

054 00:03:32,440 - 00:03:36,230

I'll use this black chariot as an example.

055 00:03:36,910 - 00:03:39,940

The chariot can move horizontally

056 00:03:40,490 - 00:03:43,150

or vertically, any number of spaces.

057 00:03:43,250 - 00:03:47,470

For example, it can move directly from here to here.

058 00:03:48,070 - 00:03:50,570

Or directly from here to here.

059 00:03:51,490 - 00:03:54,236

Both are allowed. It captures an encountered enemy piece,

060 00:03:54,236 - 00:03:55,585

but cannot jump over pieces.

061 00:03:55,890 - 00:03:57,860

Now let's introduce the advisor.

062 00:03:59,110 - 00:04:01,270

Again, I'll use Black's advisor.

063 00:04:01,760 - 00:04:04,300

Only diagonally, within the nine-point palace,

064 00:04:04,480 - 00:04:06,040

just as in Chinese chess.

065 00:04:07,330 - 00:04:10,210

Now look at the Wei, Shu and Wu pieces.

066 00:04:10,720 - 00:04:14,149

These are each side's king, equivalent to the generals in Chinese chess.

067 00:04:14,210 - 00:04:16,030

They cannot leave their palaces.

068 00:04:16,410 - 00:04:20,630

But there is a difference from the generals in Chinese chess.

069 00:04:22,300 - 00:04:24,680

Wei and Shu may face each other directly.

070 00:04:24,740 - 00:04:28,060

There is no restriction against that. Why?

071 00:04:28,120 - 00:04:29,660

If that restriction existed,

072 00:04:29,780 - 00:04:32,400

whose king would Wu's king be facing?

073 00:04:32,860 - 00:04:35,240

Right? You can think of it that way.

074 00:04:35,960 - 00:04:40,120

Of course, these three ruler pieces, Wei, Shu and Wu,

075 00:04:40,120 - 00:04:43,320

if one is checkmated, that faction loses.

076 00:04:43,780 - 00:04:46,300

I'll explain how the defeated faction is handled

077 00:04:46,360 - 00:04:47,840

later.

078 00:04:49,020 - 00:04:54,140

Now look at the horse. Like in Chinese chess, it moves in an L shape.

079 00:04:55,050 - 00:04:59,630

But unlike Chinese chess, it has no blocked-horse-leg restriction.

080 00:04:59,830 - 00:05:04,170

For example, suppose the position looks like this.

081 00:05:04,230 - 00:05:07,620

In Chinese chess, wouldn't this horse be unable to move?

082 00:05:07,680 - 00:05:10,360

Here, however, it can still jump out.

083 00:05:13,280 - 00:05:16,180

The horse also has another important role,

084 00:05:16,240 - 00:05:19,990

which I'll explain later. Now let's look at the cannon.

085 00:05:21,270 - 00:05:24,730

The cannon works much the same way,

086 00:05:24,790 - 00:05:30,030

but this game restricts cannons in the very first round.

087 00:05:30,410 - 00:05:34,410

It cannot move beyond the defensive line,

088 00:05:34,490 - 00:05:36,870

which runs through the five cities.

089 00:05:37,070 - 00:05:39,530

All five soldiers are stationed on that line.

090 00:05:39,670 - 00:05:42,050

The cannon cannot go beyond it.

091 00:05:42,110 - 00:05:45,240

It can only move sideways, or one space forward or backward.

092 00:05:45,660 - 00:05:48,840

Why? If it could move out on its very first turn,

093 00:05:49,780 - 00:05:53,920

let me just arrange this example... If it could go out immediately,

094 00:05:53,980 - 00:05:56,760

wouldn't Wu be certain to lose a chariot?

095 00:05:59,240 - 00:06:04,820

So the cannon's restriction gives Wu a first move to defend itself.

096 00:06:04,820 - 00:06:10,670

Wu may shift a cannon, jump a horse, or move a soldier sideways.

097 00:06:10,670 - 00:06:16,813

It gets that one defensive move. That's why the cannon is restricted.

098 00:06:16,813 - 00:06:17,970

We've covered

099 00:06:17,970 - 00:06:23,500

the chariot, horse, cannon and advisor. Next is the elephant. Like the horse,

100 00:06:23,500 - 00:06:29,090

in Chinese chess it has a blocking rule: its elephant's eye can be blocked.

101 00:06:29,090 - 00:06:33,710

That looks like this. If this were

102 00:06:34,280 - 00:06:36,860

Chinese chess, wouldn't the elephant be unable to move?

103 00:06:36,880 - 00:06:39,780

But here it can still jump across.

104 00:06:40,230 - 00:06:43,390

That restriction is absent. What is the purpose?

105 00:06:43,450 - 00:06:46,260

To strengthen defence, because this is a three-player game.

106 00:06:46,730 - 00:06:49,630

If we retained the blocked-elephant's-eye restriction,

107 00:06:49,690 - 00:06:51,833

it would be very disadvantageous for defence.

108 00:06:53,090 - 00:06:55,430

So, to strengthen defence,

109 00:06:55,490 - 00:06:58,160

the elephant cannot have its eye blocked.

110 00:06:58,220 - 00:07:00,800

There is one more point about the elephant.

111 00:07:00,920 - 00:07:06,350

Within its own territory, it may only move among its seven home points.

112 00:07:07,140 - 00:07:09,620

Why am I pointing this out?

113 00:07:09,680 - 00:07:12,460

When I first started playing this game,

114 00:07:13,350 - 00:07:15,850

an opponent and I once reached a position like this.

115 00:07:15,910 - 00:07:18,481

I asked, "Can these two elephants capture each other?"

116 00:07:19,000 - 00:07:22,000

They said no, because these elephants

117 00:07:22,340 - 00:07:24,600

are both on their national boundaries.

118 00:07:24,660 - 00:07:27,260

They are facing each other,

119 00:07:27,420 - 00:07:30,320

but cannot capture each other across the boundary.

120 00:07:32,000 - 00:07:33,280

There is, however,

121 00:07:33,560 - 00:07:35,640

an extra elephant rule I'll explain later.

122 00:07:35,700 - 00:07:37,033

It also applies to advisors.

123 00:07:38,700 - 00:07:41,140

Having introduced those main pieces,

124 00:07:41,200 - 00:07:43,940

let's look at the soldier. Its moves

125 00:07:43,980 - 00:07:47,980

differ quite a lot from Chinese chess.

126 00:07:48,020 - 00:07:51,000

It can move sideways from its very first move.

127 00:07:51,060 - 00:07:54,460

Like this. It can move sideways immediately.

128 00:07:54,520 - 00:07:56,040

Look at that sideways move.

129 00:07:56,060 - 00:07:59,020

If these soldiers form a connected row,

130 00:07:59,080 - 00:08:01,520

don't they make a very strong defence?

131 00:08:01,520 - 00:08:04,396

That is the original designer's intention:

132 00:08:04,396 - 00:08:07,340

to have soldiers defending along this line.

133 00:08:07,360 - 00:08:10,760

Why call it a defensive line rather than the pawn or soldier rank?

134 00:08:11,110 - 00:08:15,690

Because the soldiers can form a very powerful defence there.

135 00:08:18,000 - 00:08:21,360

On the defensive line, soldiers may move sideways but not backward.

136 00:08:21,880 - 00:08:26,480

They cannot retreat. One step forward puts them on their national boundary.

137 00:08:27,320 - 00:08:29,844

The boundary is one line ahead of the defensive line.

138 00:08:30,330 - 00:08:31,990

Here is Wei's national boundary,

139 00:08:32,150 - 00:08:33,630

Wu's national boundary,

140 00:08:34,000 - 00:08:35,440

and Shu's national boundary.

141 00:08:36,730 - 00:08:39,330

On the boundary, it moves as on the defensive line.

142 00:08:39,390 - 00:08:43,410

It may move forward or sideways, but cannot retreat to the defensive line.

143 00:08:44,170 - 00:08:46,360

But once it goes beyond the national boundary,

144 00:08:47,330 - 00:08:50,270

it may move forward, sideways or backward.

145 00:08:50,530 - 00:08:53,006

It can retreat only as far as the national boundary.

146 00:08:53,270 - 00:08:58,330

The same applies if it enters enemy territory.

147 00:08:58,810 - 00:09:02,280

In this position, imagine these advisors are absent,

148 00:09:02,340 - 00:09:04,520

leaving Shu with only its king.

149 00:09:05,140 - 00:09:10,300

The soldier can still threaten that king up on the palace's top edge.

150 00:09:14,280 - 00:09:16,380

Having explained how the pieces move,

151 00:09:16,560 - 00:09:18,420

I'll now introduce the Eastern Han.

152 00:09:18,960 - 00:09:22,077

Before the emperor is killed or an alliance forms,

153 00:09:22,077 - 00:09:24,570

Han's pieces cannot move or be captured.

154 00:09:25,030 - 00:09:29,410

But they may be used as obstacles or as cannon screens.

155 00:09:29,450 - 00:09:30,879

For example, put a cannon here

156 00:09:31,320 - 00:09:33,740

and Wu's chariot here. The cannon can capture it.

157 00:09:34,200 - 00:09:37,724

But the chariot cannot capture the cannon because the Han piece blocks it.

158 00:09:40,250 - 00:09:43,990

As for the Han emperor,

159 00:09:44,090 - 00:09:47,950

I'll explain him shortly. Now let's discuss turn order.

160 00:09:48,390 - 00:09:52,600

When I explained the cannon,

161 00:09:52,780 - 00:09:54,018

I already touched on that.

162 00:09:54,300 - 00:09:56,320

That was the issue with the cannon.

163 00:09:56,380 - 00:09:58,660

There is a similar concern with turn order:

164 00:09:58,720 - 00:10:00,100

we also have to consider

165 00:10:00,160 - 00:10:04,040

preventing Shu and Wei from attacking Wu together before it can act.

166 00:10:04,100 - 00:10:06,080

So Wu moves first.

167 00:10:06,140 - 00:10:08,360

After Wu's move,

168 00:10:08,420 - 00:10:10,480

play proceeds counterclockwise:

169 00:10:10,520 - 00:10:11,980

Wei, then Shu,

170 00:10:12,040 - 00:10:13,740

then Wu again, in that order.

171 00:10:13,800 - 00:10:15,480

Wei and Shu follow in sequence.

172 00:10:17,960 - 00:10:23,820

But if a faction is checked—for example, Wei checks Wu—

173 00:10:23,820 - 00:10:26,520

Wu is the player immediately before Wei.

174 00:10:27,070 - 00:10:31,030

When a player is in check, another rule applies: the checked player moves first.

175 00:10:32,030 - 00:10:35,370

A checked faction must respond immediately.

176 00:10:35,430 - 00:10:37,192

For example, Wu adds an advisor here.

177 00:10:38,010 - 00:10:40,130

After Wu has moved and answered the check,

178 00:10:40,190 - 00:10:42,970

its next player still moves. That is Wei.

179 00:10:43,030 - 00:10:46,470

Wei can make another move with some other piece.

180 00:10:47,440 - 00:10:49,480

So Sanguo Yan Yi Qi

181 00:10:49,540 - 00:10:55,250

has this principle of play:

182 00:10:55,250 - 00:10:59,890

players are encouraged to attack the player immediately before them.

183 00:10:59,990 - 00:11:01,140

Now,

184 00:11:01,670 - 00:11:03,410

I'll explain alliances,

185 00:11:03,470 - 00:11:05,930

and alliances versus killing the Han emperor.

186 00:11:06,830 - 00:11:12,190

Around Emperor Xian, you can see three alliance points marked Wei, Wu and Shu.

187 00:11:13,060 - 00:11:17,280

For alliances and killing the emperor, one piece is particularly important:

188 00:11:17,340 - 00:11:21,380

the horse. In this game,

189 00:11:21,440 - 00:11:24,440

the horse has a very important strategic role.

190 00:11:24,860 - 00:11:27,990

To ally with another faction,

191 00:11:28,050 - 00:11:29,710

send one of your horses over.

192 00:11:30,150 - 00:11:31,864

For example, Wei's horse jumps here.

193 00:11:32,170 - 00:11:38,210

For an alliance with Shu, jump to the Shu point; with Wu, jump to the Wu point.

194 00:11:38,210 - 00:11:43,850

But note: jumping onto the point marked with your own faction

195 00:11:43,850 - 00:11:49,390

does not have any special effect.

196 00:11:49,390 - 00:11:54,990

You may move there, but it does nothing. There is also

197 00:11:54,990 - 00:11:56,419

another point about alliances.

198 00:11:57,320 - 00:11:59,720

It does not matter whether the other player agrees,

199 00:11:59,780 - 00:12:01,360

or whether it was intentional.

200 00:12:01,420 - 00:12:04,100

For example, while repositioning my forces,

201 00:12:04,160 - 00:12:07,240

I accidentally move my horse onto the Shu point.

202 00:12:07,450 - 00:12:09,750

Even if Shu is currently attacking Wei,

203 00:12:09,810 - 00:12:11,920

the moment the horse jumps here,

204 00:12:12,140 - 00:12:15,160

the alliance takes effect and cannot be retracted.

205 00:12:15,480 - 00:12:17,840

Nor can the alliance be dissolved at will.

206 00:12:17,900 - 00:12:20,670

A condition must be met. For example,

207 00:12:21,050 - 00:12:23,010

Wei and Shu are now allied.

208 00:12:23,110 - 00:12:25,090

Move the Han marker to the Wu position.

209 00:12:26,400 - 00:12:28,160

That indicates a Wei-Shu alliance.

210 00:12:28,200 - 00:12:32,900

The yellow Han forces, three chariots and one cannon, all belong to Wu.

211 00:12:32,960 - 00:12:36,780

Wei and Shu may not capture each other's pieces.

212 00:12:36,840 - 00:12:39,160

They can only attack Wu.

213 00:12:39,220 - 00:12:42,900

Wu now has two powerful opponents,

214 00:12:42,960 - 00:12:44,920

but also receives additional forces.

215 00:12:44,980 - 00:12:49,660

So it will not be too weak by comparison.

216 00:12:50,680 - 00:12:54,980

When the two allies eliminate Wu,

217 00:12:55,780 - 00:12:57,860

Only then does it dissolve automatically.

218 00:12:57,920 - 00:13:00,180

Or if Wu eliminates either one of the allies,

219 00:13:00,530 - 00:13:03,170

the alliance also dissolves automatically.

220 00:13:05,950 - 00:13:08,664

Besides alliances, there is also killing the Han emperor.

221 00:13:08,870 - 00:13:12,510

Again, I'll use Wei as an example.

222 00:13:12,590 - 00:13:15,700

Suppose Wei captures the Han emperor.

223 00:13:16,410 - 00:13:19,130

Put the Han piece in the position of Wei's ruler.

224 00:13:20,190 - 00:13:22,090

You may remove the original ruler piece,

225 00:13:22,150 - 00:13:23,670

replacing your own ruler.

226 00:13:23,730 - 00:13:28,030

It still represents you; its role is still Wei's king.

227 00:13:29,540 - 00:13:35,824

The three yellow chariots and cannon now belong to the faction of that black

228 00:13:35,824 - 00:13:39,560

horse. The other two factions immediately form an alliance,

229 00:13:39,620 - 00:13:41,420

automatically, to oppose it.

230 00:13:42,380 - 00:13:46,880

As allies, those two may not capture each other's pieces.

231 00:13:47,020 - 00:13:49,734

They may only attack the faction that killed the emperor.

232 00:13:50,060 - 00:13:56,080

Keep that in mind. As for

233 00:13:56,080 - 00:13:59,540

Han's role in balancing the forces,

234 00:13:59,620 - 00:14:03,320

I have one particular addition to suggest.

235 00:14:04,510 - 00:14:08,050

Suppose neither an alliance nor the killing of the emperor has occurred.

236 00:14:09,020 - 00:14:16,020

Wei then checkmates Wu, and Wei takes over

237 00:14:20,410 - 00:14:21,970

Wu's remaining pieces.

238 00:14:22,220 - 00:14:23,960

More on taking over pieces later.

239 00:14:24,020 - 00:14:25,639

For now, let me give this example.

240 00:14:26,370 - 00:14:29,140

Shu still has only its original forces,

241 00:14:29,200 - 00:14:31,860

while Wei now has a powerful army.

242 00:14:32,400 - 00:14:34,560

If Wei then kills the Han emperor as well,

243 00:14:34,620 - 00:14:37,560

wouldn't the battle become completely one-sided?

244 00:14:38,360 - 00:14:42,480

So, with the balance of forces in mind,

245 00:14:43,560 - 00:14:50,560

when I first learned the game, I made this suggestion to the official designers:

246 00:14:51,100 - 00:14:56,670

if one side checkmates another before an alliance or the emperor's death,

247 00:14:56,670 - 00:15:02,360

could we give Han directly to the third faction to reinforce it?

248 00:15:02,360 - 00:15:07,990

In other words, the moment Wei checkmates Wu,

249 00:15:07,990 - 00:15:13,970

Han activates and its three chariots and cannon go to Shu.

250 00:15:13,970 - 00:15:16,110

That would happen even without

251 00:15:16,940 - 00:15:18,900

an alliance or killing the emperor.

252 00:15:19,200 - 00:15:20,960

Han would activate automatically,

253 00:15:21,020 - 00:15:24,600

because it exists to balance the forces on the board.

254 00:15:25,240 - 00:15:27,760

If those forces become unbalanced,

255 00:15:27,820 - 00:15:29,400

and Han plays no role,

256 00:15:29,500 - 00:15:34,120

then including Han as a balancing force would be entirely pointless.

257 00:15:35,310 - 00:15:37,030

For that reason,

258 00:15:37,090 - 00:15:39,330

I suggested adding this rule.

259 00:15:39,390 - 00:15:41,390

The officials said they would consider it.

260 00:15:46,690 - 00:15:48,880

Now let's discuss taking over defeated armies.

261 00:15:50,550 - 00:15:53,520

There is quite a lot to say about this.

262 00:15:55,010 - 00:15:56,170

First of all,

263 00:15:56,930 - 00:16:02,490

when one faction checkmates another,

264 00:16:02,490 - 00:16:08,900

all the defeated faction's surviving pieces belong to the victor.

265 00:16:08,900 - 00:16:15,370

If Wei checkmates Wu, all Wu's pieces become Wei's.

266 00:16:15,370 - 00:16:22,370

Advisors, elephants, chariots, horses and cannons: all come under its control.

267 00:16:23,070 - 00:16:30,070

The captured advisors and elephants can also

268 00:16:30,640 - 00:16:34,900

be commanded. Remember the extra rule I mentioned for elephants?

269 00:16:35,640 - 00:16:39,640

After Wei takes over all of Wu's pieces,

270 00:16:39,800 - 00:16:45,010

Wu's elephants may cross the national boundary to help defend Wei.

271 00:16:45,980 - 00:16:50,340

If Wei is able to do so,

272 00:16:50,800 - 00:16:54,260

it can also bring these two advisors over.

273 00:16:54,690 - 00:16:57,710

The advisors do not walk over one step at a time.

274 00:16:57,710 - 00:17:00,400

We add a "palace transfer" rule instead.

275 00:17:00,460 - 00:17:04,980

Whether Wei has only one advisor left or still has both,

276 00:17:05,080 - 00:17:07,880

it may want to strengthen its defence.

277 00:17:08,330 - 00:17:11,220

It can transfer these two advisors into its own palace.

278 00:17:11,280 - 00:17:13,340

Use points an advisor can normally reach.

279 00:17:13,750 - 00:17:15,510

You cannot put an advisor here,

280 00:17:15,570 - 00:17:19,140

right? Bring it here to help defend.

281 00:17:19,240 - 00:17:23,410

Like this. A palace transfer

282 00:17:23,510 - 00:17:27,330

has one restriction: it must consume a move.

283 00:17:27,690 - 00:17:29,290

You cannot transfer an advisor

284 00:17:29,350 - 00:17:31,493

and then move another piece in the same turn.

285 00:17:33,980 - 00:17:37,220

That covers using captured advisors and elephants for defence.

286 00:17:37,630 - 00:17:39,868

The elephants can jump over one move at a time.

287 00:17:40,810 - 00:17:43,130

Of course, the condition for that

288 00:17:43,350 - 00:17:46,470

For an elephant to cross into a neighbouring country

289 00:17:46,530 - 00:17:52,950

and help defend, the two factions involved must be Wu and Wei, or Wu and Shu.

290 00:17:52,950 - 00:17:55,410

This follows taking over the other's pieces.

291 00:17:55,450 - 00:17:58,910

For Wei and Shu, suppose Wei checkmates Shu.

292 00:17:58,970 - 00:18:01,610

Shu's elephants cannot cross over,

293 00:18:01,670 - 00:18:03,390

because Wu is enemy territory.

294 00:18:04,730 - 00:18:10,370

But if Shu had killed the emperor before Wei checkmated it,

295 00:18:10,370 - 00:18:16,030

Shu's elephant could pass through Wei... through Han territory

296 00:18:16,030 - 00:18:17,250

to reach

297 00:18:18,020 - 00:18:21,300

Wei's territory here. The reverse works the same way.

298 00:18:21,750 - 00:18:26,220

If Shu checkmates Wei,

299 00:18:26,280 - 00:18:27,947

and Wei had killed the Han emperor,

300 00:18:29,250 - 00:18:34,760

Wei's elephants may also pass through Han territory

301 00:18:34,760 - 00:18:38,000

to reach Shu. But that is a very long journey for an elephant.

302 00:18:38,220 - 00:18:40,330

In practice, this rule

303 00:18:41,780 - 00:18:46,060

is somewhat questionable. You would hardly bring an elephant all that way.

304 00:18:46,290 - 00:18:48,750

Besides, the route is dangerous.

305 00:18:48,810 - 00:18:50,870

The elephant might be captured at any time.

306 00:18:53,510 - 00:18:55,590

Finally, let's discuss winning and losing.

307 00:18:56,390 - 00:18:58,710

There are wins, losses and draws.

308 00:18:58,770 - 00:19:04,030

If your faction checkmates both other factions,

309 00:19:04,090 - 00:19:09,500

you win. If Wu first checkmates Wei,

310 00:19:09,730 - 00:19:11,510

but is then checkmated by Shu,

311 00:19:11,570 - 00:19:13,230

Shu is the final winner.

312 00:19:15,820 - 00:19:18,540

If none of the three can checkmate another,

313 00:19:18,600 - 00:19:21,040

or if Wu checkmates Wei,

314 00:19:21,100 - 00:19:23,148

but Wu and Shu cannot checkmate each other,

315 00:19:24,320 - 00:19:26,340

Wu and Shu draw,

316 00:19:26,400 - 00:19:33,400

while Wei has lost.

317 00:19:35,130 - 00:19:37,810

There is also something

318 00:19:39,180 - 00:19:40,980

about alliances

319 00:19:41,400 - 00:19:42,600

that I forgot to mention.

320 00:19:42,640 - 00:19:46,900

Allied factions do not give check to each other.

321 00:19:47,620 - 00:19:53,330

For example, suppose Wu and Shu

322 00:19:53,330 - 00:19:59,050

are allied, and Wei gives check to Wu's king.

323 00:19:59,600 - 00:20:00,980

The king may hide here,

324 00:20:01,060 - 00:20:02,580

behind Shu's

325 00:20:02,640 - 00:20:05,940

chariot. That is neither check nor offering the king for capture.

326 00:20:07,160 - 00:20:09,400

It is normal protection of an ally,

327 00:20:10,560 - 00:20:12,540

or assistance with defence.

328 00:20:13,120 - 00:20:15,800

So that position does not count as check.

329 00:20:15,860 - 00:20:19,340

Also, if Wei's chariot pins it from here,

330 00:20:19,680 - 00:20:22,770

Shu's chariot may only move forward or backward.

331 00:20:22,830 - 00:20:26,510

It cannot move sideways, since that exposes its ally's king to capture.

332 00:20:26,970 - 00:20:31,490

That is one restriction after forming an alliance.

333 00:20:33,740 - 00:20:39,080

There is also the matter of giving check.

334 00:20:39,420 - 00:20:45,070

The same principle applies here.

335 00:20:46,120 - 00:20:49,120

You know Chinese chess has a rule about perpetual check, right?

336 00:20:51,360 - 00:20:58,360

Suppose Wei repeatedly checks Wu.

337 00:20:59,940 - 00:21:02,940

Check here, the king moves here, then Wei checks again.

338 00:21:03,000 - 00:21:07,060

That's checkmate—wrong example. I mean checking back and forth.

339 00:21:08,580 - 00:21:12,720

that is pointless.

340 00:21:13,510 - 00:21:14,790

So there is a restriction

341 00:21:14,850 - 00:21:17,755

on perpetual check against the player immediately before you.

342 00:21:17,880 - 00:21:20,820

Once it reaches a specified number of rounds,

343 00:21:20,880 - 00:21:25,460

you can set six or nine rounds. If it still won't change moves,

344 00:21:25,640 - 00:21:27,180

it automatically loses.

345 00:21:28,610 - 00:21:31,753

All its pieces are taken over by the player immediately before it.

346 00:21:32,820 - 00:21:36,660

But what about perpetually checking the next player?

347 00:21:37,940 - 00:21:39,090

For example,

348 00:21:39,620 - 00:21:41,100

let me remove these pieces

349 00:21:43,670 - 00:21:46,820

and put two chariots here. If it keeps doing this...

350 00:21:47,030 - 00:21:48,750

Suppose Wei moves here.

351 00:21:49,450 - 00:21:51,800

[Brief phrase unclear.] It gives check,

352 00:21:51,960 - 00:21:55,390

and the king moves. Wu checks Wei.

353 00:21:55,450 - 00:21:56,890

After Wei responds,

354 00:21:57,260 - 00:22:00,820

it is Shu's turn. Shu makes any move.

355 00:22:01,020 - 00:22:03,230

Then Wu checks again,

356 00:22:03,310 - 00:22:05,072

Wei moves again, and Shu moves again.

357 00:22:05,190 - 00:22:10,700

Look: that has not disrupted the normal turn order,

358 00:22:10,700 - 00:22:14,260

has it? So perpetual check of the previous player loses if unchanged,

359 00:22:14,320 - 00:22:16,701

but perpetual check of the next player is allowed.

360 00:22:17,090 - 00:22:20,410

Checking the next player does not disrupt the normal turn order,

361 00:22:20,510 - 00:22:22,010

so it is allowed.

362 00:22:22,070 - 00:22:23,220

There is also

363 00:22:40,060 - 00:22:42,920

the matter of the board's edges and corners.

364 00:22:44,690 - 00:22:48,590

I have something to say about those.

365 00:22:49,280 - 00:22:54,780

A friend once asked me this question:

366 00:22:54,880 - 00:22:56,460

"Can this chariot move here?"

367 00:22:57,460 - 00:23:01,940

Some boards draw the outside border just like the playable grid lines.

368 00:23:02,350 - 00:23:04,160

He asked, "Can the chariot move here?"

369 00:23:05,660 - 00:23:08,210

And what about a cannon or a soldier?

370 00:23:08,630 - 00:23:10,550

That nearly made me burst out laughing.

371 00:23:11,590 - 00:23:14,930

I said, "How are you moving outside the board?"

372 00:23:14,990 - 00:23:18,130

Chariot and cannon aside, how would a soldier get there?

373 00:23:18,190 - 00:23:20,820

"You moved it there in one step?" He said yes.

374 00:23:21,820 - 00:23:24,340

I said that was wrong. This outer border

375 00:23:24,620 - 00:23:26,960

cannot be entered by any piece.

376 00:23:28,250 - 00:23:30,155

The horse and elephant are no exception.

377 00:23:30,350 - 00:23:31,790

Let me remove these pieces.

378 00:23:32,090 - 00:23:33,566

For example, with a horse here,

379 00:23:33,750 - 00:23:36,530

it cannot jump straight over and capture this soldier.

380 00:23:38,020 - 00:23:39,780

As for how the horse moves,

381 00:23:40,750 - 00:23:46,250

think of its L-shaped move as one straight step and one diagonal step,

382 00:23:46,250 - 00:23:52,320

two component moves. This horse can move here, or here,

383 00:23:52,860 - 00:23:58,370

and here or here. But it cannot move to this point, because its straight step

384 00:23:58,370 - 00:24:03,950

stays on a valid line, but the diagonal step crosses this blank area.

385 00:24:03,950 - 00:24:09,490

So that move is illegal. With the horse here, it may move

386 00:24:09,490 - 00:24:13,560

here, here, here and here.

387 00:24:14,920 - 00:24:18,349

It cannot go here: both its straight and diagonal steps leave the board.

388 00:24:18,580 - 00:24:23,670

That is also illegal. If the horse is here,

389 00:24:24,990 - 00:24:27,090

it can move here or here,

390 00:24:28,020 - 00:24:29,730

here or here,

391 00:24:30,910 - 00:24:35,150

and here or here. At this point, the straight step stays on the grid,

392 00:24:35,210 - 00:24:38,020

but the diagonal step goes outside, so that is illegal too.

393 00:24:38,210 - 00:24:41,950

Therefore, for this piece,

394 00:24:42,170 - 00:24:45,040

the horse, its route

395 00:24:45,780 - 00:24:49,410

cannot cross these areas designated for minority peoples.

396 00:24:49,470 - 00:24:52,830

Those blank regions around the board's corners cannot be crossed,

397 00:24:53,260 - 00:24:55,740

whether with the straight step or the diagonal step.

398 00:24:56,510 - 00:24:57,990

The elephant is the same.

399 00:24:58,150 - 00:25:02,690

I said a captured elephant could cross the national boundary to help defend.

400 00:25:03,060 - 00:25:04,480

It may cross this way,

401 00:25:04,540 - 00:25:06,280

but cannot cross this other way,

402 00:25:07,180 - 00:25:10,460

because it has the same restriction as the horse.

403 00:25:20,010 - 00:25:24,490

Here is another point about winning and losing.

404 00:25:24,610 - 00:25:26,230

Suppose, for example,

405 00:25:27,130 - 00:25:30,310

Mid-game, I no longer want to play. Can I resign? Yes.

406 00:25:30,410 - 00:25:32,350

You may resign, but your pieces,

407 00:25:32,570 - 00:25:33,790

wherever they are,

408 00:25:34,910 - 00:25:36,060

become inactive.

409 00:25:36,520 - 00:25:39,720

They are not taken over as they would be after checkmate.

410 00:25:39,780 - 00:25:41,560

They simply become inactive.

411 00:25:42,040 - 00:25:43,520

They stay on the board,

412 00:25:43,580 - 00:25:45,480

and neither opponent takes them over.

413 00:25:45,740 - 00:25:48,020

Turn your king piece face down

414 00:25:48,080 - 00:25:49,560

to indicate your resignation.

415 00:25:49,880 - 00:25:53,213

The other two factions fight each other or compete for control of Han.

416 00:25:53,300 - 00:25:55,300

But your own pieces are entirely inactive.

417 00:25:59,420 - 00:26:02,920

They can be used as obstacles,

418 00:26:05,180 - 00:26:06,500

or, in other words,

419 00:26:06,890 - 00:26:09,130

as cannon screens or obstacles.

420 00:26:09,190 - 00:26:11,510

The other players may also capture them.

421 00:26:11,950 - 00:26:13,100

They can be captured.

422 00:26:13,610 - 00:26:16,450

They do not turn into immovable stones.

423 00:26:16,940 - 00:26:18,090

That's not what happens.

424 00:26:28,980 - 00:26:34,910

Now, recording a Sanguo Yan Yi Qi game.

425 00:26:34,910 - 00:26:40,710

The board has seventeen lines

426 00:26:40,710 - 00:26:42,930

by seventeen lines.

427 00:26:46,230 - 00:26:48,930

Here is how its game notation works.

428 00:26:49,680 - 00:26:51,160

First, the coordinates.

429 00:26:51,220 - 00:26:56,770

From each side's right to left, the files are numbered one, two,

430 00:26:56,770 - 00:27:00,350

three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, up to seventeen.

431 00:27:01,100 - 00:27:06,170

Each side does this. For Wu, the chariots are on files five and thirteen.

432 00:27:06,290 - 00:27:10,760

The central file is nine; the king starts on file nine.

433 00:27:12,690 - 00:27:17,100

Its files one through four correspond to Wei's side,

434 00:27:18,270 - 00:27:20,413

and fourteen through seventeen to Shu's side.

435 00:27:20,910 - 00:27:25,070

If Wu kills the Han emperor,

436 00:27:25,960 - 00:27:29,560

the four Han pieces use Wu's coordinates for their moves,

437 00:27:29,620 - 00:27:32,300

rather than Han's. Han has no coordinates of its own.

438 00:27:32,640 - 00:27:34,926

Remember: Han has no separate coordinate system.

439 00:27:35,600 - 00:27:37,200

Whoever kills the emperor,

440 00:27:37,990 - 00:27:41,540

the three Han chariots and cannon use that faction's coordinates.

441 00:27:41,600 - 00:27:46,170

For Wu, after killing the emperor, these are files seven, nine and eleven.

442 00:27:46,740 - 00:27:49,580

For Wei, they are files four and three.

443 00:27:50,120 - 00:27:52,263

For Shu, they are files fourteen and fifteen.

444 00:27:52,850 - 00:27:59,280

Keep that in mind. Now suppose

445 00:27:59,920 - 00:28:02,860

these two Wei cannons are both on the same file,

446 00:28:02,920 - 00:28:04,880

which is file ten from Wei's perspective.

447 00:28:05,580 - 00:28:08,720

If you want to move the rear cannon,

448 00:28:09,190 - 00:28:12,870

write "Rear cannon, sideways to file seven."

449 00:28:15,780 - 00:28:20,910

They share a file. "Cannon on file 10 to 7"—which cannon?

450 00:28:21,100 - 00:28:28,100

Similarly, after Wei kills the emperor, suppose

451 00:28:28,520 - 00:28:34,440

you move the middle cannon: "Middle cannon to file ten"—actually, "to file seven."

452 00:28:36,960 - 00:28:43,130

Here is an even more extreme case: after Wei kills the emperor,

453 00:28:43,130 - 00:28:47,290

all five chariots line up on one file. How do you distinguish them?

454 00:28:47,750 - 00:28:52,810

Use one, two, three, four and five; distinguish them by number.

455 00:28:52,870 - 00:28:56,390

Lower numbers mean farther forward; higher numbers mean farther back.

456 00:28:56,820 - 00:28:59,890

For example: "4th chariot, sideways to file 9,"

457 00:29:00,670 - 00:29:03,870

not "Chariot on file 4 to file 9"—which of the five chariots?

458 00:29:04,330 - 00:29:11,330

Right? There is also another possibility,

459 00:29:12,400 - 00:29:14,160

which can occur in theory,

460 00:29:14,220 - 00:29:15,440

but not in actual play.

461 00:29:15,910 - 00:29:18,270

If Wei both kills the emperor and defeats Wu,

462 00:29:19,230 - 00:29:21,430

all seven chariots are on file 4.

463 00:29:21,470 - 00:29:23,710

Of course, that is completely unrealistic.

464 00:29:23,770 - 00:29:26,870

But to explain how moves are recorded,

465 00:29:27,150 - 00:29:31,930

I'll include it: number them one, two, three, four, five, six and seven.

466 00:29:32,030 - 00:29:33,910

The same principle applies:

467 00:29:34,170 - 00:29:37,110

lower numbers are farther forward, higher numbers farther back.

468 00:29:37,170 - 00:29:38,590

If this chariot moves here,

469 00:29:38,650 - 00:29:40,840

write "Sixth chariot, sideways to file seven,"

470 00:29:41,170 - 00:29:42,730

because it is sixth in the line.

471 00:29:49,990 - 00:29:55,520

Also, the creator mentioned earlier [name unclear]

472 00:29:55,520 - 00:29:59,900

suggested in a video

473 00:30:00,420 - 00:30:02,753

that each full round should represent one season.

474 00:30:02,820 - 00:30:07,610

I think that is quite good. Let me explain why.

475 00:30:08,050 - 00:30:11,590

First, I strongly oppose having one round represent one month.

476 00:30:11,650 - 00:30:15,570

That would make twelve rounds a year.

477 00:30:16,980 - 00:30:21,580

One move each by Wu, Wei and Shu would count as a month,

478 00:30:22,260 - 00:30:24,060

and twelve moves each as a year.

479 00:30:24,120 - 00:30:29,670

The longest game of this variant I've seen lasted 117 rounds.

480 00:30:29,670 - 00:30:34,160

That would settle the Three Kingdoms conflict in under ten years.

481 00:30:36,740 - 00:30:38,280

Ten years? Never mind ten;

482 00:30:38,340 - 00:30:41,040

the Three Kingdoms war was still going after thirty years.

483 00:30:41,100 - 00:30:45,620

So one round per month is entirely unreasonable.

484 00:30:46,280 - 00:30:47,560

Now consider one season.

485 00:30:47,620 - 00:30:49,220

With one season per full round,

486 00:30:49,260 - 00:30:52,240

four rounds make a year.

487 00:30:53,180 - 00:30:57,800

Again, using a maximum of 120 rounds,

488 00:30:58,340 - 00:30:59,880

in less than thirty years

489 00:30:59,960 - 00:31:02,020

the war would already be over.

490 00:31:02,690 - 00:31:04,071

Isn't that still rather slow?

491 00:31:05,480 - 00:31:08,540

Starting in AD 220 would bring us to AD 250,

492 00:31:08,940 - 00:31:10,845

when Shu had not even fallen yet, right?

493 00:31:12,580 - 00:31:16,740

The conflict began with the Yellow Turban Rebellion in AD 184,

494 00:31:16,800 - 00:31:19,370

and ended in AD 280, when Western Jin conquered Wu.

495 00:31:19,530 - 00:31:21,030

That is ninety-six years.

496 00:31:21,660 - 00:31:24,240

Ninety-six years corresponding to ninety-six rounds

497 00:31:24,300 - 00:31:25,840

would be ideal.

498 00:31:27,140 - 00:31:29,450

So whether it is a season

499 00:31:29,510 - 00:31:32,930

or a month per round, neither is as good as one year per round.

500 00:31:33,310 - 00:31:35,400

In other words, Wu makes one move,

501 00:31:35,640 - 00:31:37,688

Wei makes one move, and Shu makes one move.

502 00:31:37,810 - 00:31:40,950

That completes one round,

503 00:31:41,170 - 00:31:45,710

which represents one year. There is also

504 00:31:46,310 - 00:31:49,650

the official convention for recording moves.

505 00:31:49,710 - 00:31:52,310

They begin in AD 189,

506 00:31:52,370 - 00:31:54,310

the year of Dong Zhuo's upheaval.

507 00:31:56,100 - 00:31:58,400

I don't think that is a good choice. Why?

508 00:31:58,910 - 00:32:02,170

The conflict should begin in AD 184.

509 00:32:02,230 - 00:32:04,720

Without the Yellow Turban Rebellion,

510 00:32:04,780 - 00:32:07,780

there would not have been the later regional separatist powers.

511 00:32:08,310 - 00:32:11,470

Without those powers, there would be no Three Kingdoms period.

512 00:32:11,650 - 00:32:15,680

So its roots should be traced to AD 184,

513 00:32:15,740 - 00:32:17,788

rather than Dong Zhuo's upheaval in AD 189.

514 00:32:21,960 - 00:32:25,340

That is about it for the rules.

515 00:32:26,710 - 00:32:29,450

Now I'll introduce a few small tactical tips.

516 00:32:29,530 - 00:32:35,140

One famous tactic in this game is "killing with a borrowed knife."

517 00:32:35,140 - 00:32:39,590

Let me give another example.

518 00:32:42,310 - 00:32:45,350

Wei jumps its horse here.

519 00:32:45,890 - 00:32:47,950

After Wei moves, it is Shu's turn.

520 00:32:48,250 - 00:32:50,980

Shu can capture that horse.

521 00:32:51,470 - 00:32:53,375

That is "killing with a borrowed knife."

522 00:32:55,880 - 00:32:58,280

Also: two birds with one stone,

523 00:32:58,340 - 00:33:03,920

or three birds with one arrow. Those are particularly complex,

524 00:33:03,920 - 00:33:05,893

so I won't explain them further. Instead,

525 00:33:05,893 - 00:33:08,491

let's discuss one chariot defending against one horse.

526 00:33:10,120 - 00:33:13,110

If this horse wants to kill the emperor,

527 00:33:13,910 - 00:33:16,243

the best piece to defend against it is a chariot.

528 00:33:17,940 - 00:33:20,060

For example, if the horse reaches this point,

529 00:33:20,120 - 00:33:22,120

the best position for the chariot is here,

530 00:33:22,530 - 00:33:25,810

because it can cover both of the horse's attacking routes.

531 00:33:26,730 - 00:33:29,670

But if the horse jumps here,

532 00:33:30,150 - 00:33:32,130

one chariot cannot stop it.

533 00:33:32,190 - 00:33:34,070

If the chariot watches this route,

534 00:33:34,250 - 00:33:36,290

it can cover this point, but not that one.

535 00:33:36,630 - 00:33:38,850

You need two chariots stationed here.

536 00:33:40,370 - 00:33:41,950

Pay particular attention to that.

537 00:33:43,020 - 00:33:46,260

Remember the pattern of a square divided into four smaller squares.

538 00:33:46,320 - 00:33:50,670

When the horse and chariot form that pattern,

539 00:33:50,750 - 00:33:52,590

the horse cannot reach this point,

540 00:33:52,650 - 00:33:53,810

or even this point.

541 00:33:53,870 - 00:33:59,190

It can only retreat. So,

542 00:34:00,700 - 00:34:03,420

with the horse here, one chariot cannot defend.

543 00:34:03,480 - 00:34:04,800

But if it is here,

544 00:34:05,000 - 00:34:06,180

here, here or here,

545 00:34:06,720 - 00:34:08,380
one chariot can defend.

546 00:34:08,620 - 00:34:10,380
If the horse jumps here,

547 00:34:10,440 - 00:34:12,821
the chariot can stand here. The same applies here.

548 00:34:13,880 - 00:34:15,300
When the horse jumps here,

549 00:34:15,360 - 00:34:17,100
the chariot can defend from here.

550 00:34:18,370 - 00:34:22,620
And also here. That's how one chariot prevents a horse from killing the emperor.

551 00:34:24,430 - 00:34:26,150
Of course, a horse

552 00:34:26,210 - 00:34:28,810
that jumps into this Han area

553 00:34:29,050 - 00:34:33,280
will destabilise the position, so whichever faction it belongs to,

554 00:34:33,360 - 00:34:35,074
if it casually jumps its horse here,

555 00:34:35,420 - 00:34:38,420
it will very quickly face defensive action from both opponents.

556 00:34:38,890 - 00:34:40,190
That is inevitable.

557 00:34:40,510 - 00:34:42,290
After the horse kills the emperor,

558 00:34:42,650 - 00:34:48,020
those three chariots and one cannon are truly frightening,

559 00:34:48,080 - 00:34:52,210
aren't they? They are a very intimidating force.

560 00:34:52,490 - 00:34:53,830
So that horse,

561 00:34:54,200 - 00:34:57,080
wherever it goes near Han,

562 00:34:57,140 - 00:35:00,854
must be guarded against, even at the cost of sacrificing a chariot to stop it.

563 00:35:03,440 - 00:35:07,210
Another example:

564 00:35:07,950 - 00:35:11,730
after an alliance, how should the third faction defend?

565 00:35:12,420 - 00:35:16,540
On its next move, the horse can fork both chariots, like this.

566 00:35:17,250 - 00:35:22,960
It can even trade the horse for a chariot. So, once an alliance forms,

567 00:35:24,470 - 00:35:26,770
for example, an alliance with Shu,

568 00:35:26,830 - 00:35:30,070
on Wei's next turn it must protect these two chariots.

569 00:35:30,810 - 00:35:34,539
I suggest moving this chariot well away. Anywhere will do,

570 00:35:34,539 - 00:35:36,660
to avoid a fork [pieces unclear].

571 00:35:37,950 - 00:35:39,807
If you move this other chariot instead,

572 00:35:40,360 - 00:35:44,074
after taking the cannon it still forks two chariots; this one cannot be saved.

573 00:35:46,770 - 00:35:51,900
Similarly, when Wu and Wei form an alliance,

574 00:35:51,960 - 00:35:57,300
Shu also has these two chariots to protect; move this one well away.

575 00:35:58,090 - 00:36:00,470
Then the horse cannot fork both chariots.

576 00:36:01,410 - 00:36:03,850
There is one special case, however.

577 00:36:05,600 - 00:36:09,180
If Shu allies with Wu in this position, you can ignore the horse here.

578 00:36:09,590 - 00:36:13,850
Look: two of those square patterns completely contain the horse.

579 00:36:19,590 - 00:36:22,638
That concludes my introduction to the rules of Sanguo Yan Yi Qi.

580 00:36:23,090 - 00:36:24,290
I'll finish here.

581 00:36:24,960 - 00:36:28,960
I had recorded some earlier videos,

582 00:36:29,020 - 00:36:30,400
but deleted all of them.

583 00:36:30,810 - 00:36:33,050
I'm very sorry about that.

584 00:36:33,610 - 00:36:35,790
This video was also prompted by

585 00:36:36,140 - 00:36:41,000
the great enthusiasm of that Bilibili creator [name unclear].

586 00:36:41,060 - 00:36:43,740
So I remade the tutorial.

587 00:36:44,420 - 00:36:46,620
Please forgive any shortcomings.

588 00:36:47,380 - 00:36:48,760
That's all for this video.